

Strategic Initiative Status Report – Q2 2026

Progress Tracking: CSO Priority Initiatives

Date: 12 June 2026

Classification: Internal

Prepared by: Strategy Office

Review Cycle: Quarterly

1. Initiative Portfolio Summary

Initiative	Owner	Budget (USD)	Progress	Status
Financial Innovation Hub Phase 2	Innovation Division	4,200,000	68%	On Track
Digital Asset Licensing Fast-Track	Regulatory Affairs	850,000	45%	At Risk
ESG Reporting Framework	Sustainability	310,000	80%	On Track
CSO Intelligence Dashboard	Technology	620,000	30%	Behind
GCC Bilateral Agreements	External Affairs	180,000	55%	On Track
Talent Attraction Programme	HR	1,100,000	40%	At Risk
Core Registry Upgrade	Technology	2,900,000	15%	Behind

2. Initiatives Requiring Leadership Attention

Two initiatives are currently flagged as 'At Risk' and two as 'Behind Schedule'. The CSO's attention is requested on the following:

- Digital Asset Licensing Fast-Track (At Risk): Consultant delivery delayed by 3 weeks. Revised SLA from legal team still outstanding. Risk of missing the Q3 2026 go-live target which would cede first-mover advantage to DIFC.
- Talent Attraction Programme (At Risk): Visa processing delays averaging 47 days are deterring senior international candidates. Escalation to immigration authority required at ministerial level.
- CSO Intelligence Dashboard (Behind): Technology vendor change mid-project caused a 6-week delay. New delivery date: 15 September 2026. Contingency: manual reporting continues.
- Core Registry Upgrade (Behind): Procurement process extended due to additional security review requirements. Revised kick-off: 1 August 2026.

3. Completed Milestones – Q2 2026

- Financial Innovation Hub: Three anchor tenants signed (global payments firm, regtech startup, Islamic fintech). Opening ceremony scheduled September 2026.
- ESG Reporting Framework: Draft framework circulated to 45 licensed entities; 38 responses received. Final version due July 2026.
- GCC Bilateral Agreements: MOU signed with Bahrain Economic Development Board; discussions advanced with Kuwait CMA.

4. Budget Utilization

Initiative	Approved Budget	Spent to Date	Remaining	Forecast at Comple
Innovation Hub Ph.2	\$4,200,000	\$2,856,000	\$1,344,000	\$4,200,000
Digital Asset Fast-Track	\$850,000	\$382,500	\$467,500	\$920,000
ESG Framework	\$310,000	\$248,000	\$62,000	\$310,000
CSO Dashboard	\$620,000	\$186,000	\$434,000	\$680,000
Registry Upgrade	\$2,900,000	\$435,000	\$2,465,000	\$3,100,000